

Letter Writing

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‘A Letter in technical writing is what medicine is to a patient.’

- Letters play an important role to enhance and establish a lasting relationship within the companies, institutions, and organization
- A good letter is a master key that opens the locked doors to expand the business. It can be informational, persuasive, motivational or promotional.

Types of Letter Writing:

1. Formal Letter
2. Informal Letter

1. Formal Letter

- Office Communication
- Used for Specific Audience
- Jargons are used

2. Informal Letter

- Friendly Communication
- Used for General Audience
- No need of Jargons or pompous words

Structure of Letter:

1. Heading/ Your Address/ Sender's Address:

- This element shows organization's or sender's name, full address, and telephone numbers.
- Skip a line between your address and date.

2. Date:

- Put the date on which the letter was written in the format – Month Date Year or Date month Year. For example “August 15, 2013”

or

“15th August, 2013”

- Skip a line between date and inside address.

3. Inside Address:

- This part of the letter writing introduces the address of the person you are writing to along with the name of the recipient, its title and company name, the street address, post office box number, and the city and state.

“Ms. Rose Sheron
Corporate Communications Inc.
Chicago, IL 60611
USA”

- Skip a line between inside address and subject line.

4. Subject Line:

- It lets the recipient to find out what the letter is about at a glance. It can be placed above the Salutation or below the Salutation, i.e.
 - “Subject: Request to provide project file.

Dear Devang Patel:”

- “Dear Devang Patel:

Subject: Request to provide project file.”

- Skip a line between subject line and salutation.

5. Salutation or The Greeting:

- The Greeting will address the individual that the letter is being sent to. This is usually in the form of ‘Respected Sir’ or ‘Dear Sir’. You may write salutation such as:

“Dear Students:

Dear Members:

Dear Devang Patel:

Honorable Sir:

Respected Chief Guest:

Ladies and Gentlemen:

To Whom It May Concern:

Dear Sir or Madam:”

- Note that there is a colon after the salutation. Be sure to use a colon at the end of the name, not a comma as in personal letters.
- Skip a line between salutation and the message.

6. Message or Body or Text:

- The message or body or text where you write the content of the letter; the paragraphs should be single spaced with a skipped line between each paragraph.
- Skip a line between message and complimentary close.

7. Complimentary Close or The Closing:

- This part of the letter is a single word or phrase. The letter usually ends with such words:

“Sincerely,	Yours sincerely,
Cordially,	Yours obediently,
Truly,	Yours faithfully,
Faithfully,	Faithfully yours,
Respectfully,	Truly yours, etc.”

- Note that there is a comma after the end of the closing or complimentary close and only the first word is capitalized.
- Skip a line between complimentary close and signature box.

8. Signature Block:

- Your signature, name, and title will go in this section, i.e.

“Yours Sincerely,

Ms. Priti Patel

- An unsigned letter is of no value.
- Skip a line between signature block and enclosure.

9. Enclosure:

- If your letter contains other document, other than the letter itself, your letter will include the word ‘Enclosure’, i.e.

“Enclosure: A copy of project file.”

- This part of the letter appears at the bottom of the letter.

Letters with specific purposes

Cover letters

- When you send a report or some other document to your supervisor, send it with a cover letter that briefly explains the purpose of the report and your major findings.

Letters of inquiry

- You may want to request information about a company or organization such as whether they anticipate job openings in the near future or whether they fund grant proposals from non-profit groups.

Job application letters

- Whether responding to job announcements online or on paper, you are likely to write a job application letter introducing yourself and your skills to a potential employer.

Follow-up letters

- Any time you have made a request of someone, write a follow-up letter expressing your appreciation for the time your letter-recipient has taken to respond to your needs or consider your job application.
- Letters within the professional context may take on many other purposes, but these four types of letters are some of the most common that you will encounter.

Roger McMahon
32598 Collins Way
Redmond, OR 97756
(541) 567-2546

Letterhead
(sender's return
address)

September 28, 2015

Spacing above and below the date can vary to make the text fit logically on the page.

Tina Blakely, Owner
Three Creeks Spa Service
12129 Lone Tree Place
Sisters, OR 97759

Inside address: the name, title, and address of the intended recipient

Dear Ms. Blakely:

Use a formal title and last name in the greeting, unless you are close friends with the recipient. Follow the greeting with a colon.

Enclosed you will find my final report on team building for employees at Three Creeks Spa Service. I am excited to have you review my findings which include extensive research of strategies that have been successful for other organizations like Three Creeks. In my informal conversations with some of the other staff at Three Creeks, I know they are also excited to explore some of these team-building activities.

If you have any questions about the content in this report, please don't hesitate to contact me either by phone at the phone number above or in person at the shop. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss this with you further.

Sincerely,

Roger McMahon

Roger McMahon
Three Creeks Spa Service Dispatcher

Line spacing: Leave one blank line after the address, the greeting, and each paragraph in the body. After the complimentary closing, (Sincerely, Yours truly, etc.), leave four lines as space for a signature, then type the sender's full name and title on two lines as shown here.

Formal Letter Sample

D-11 Adarsh Society,
DS Marg, Lower Parel,
Mumbai 400 008.

11th June 2020

To,
The Editor-in-Chief,
Hindustan Times, Main Street,
Mumbai 400 001,

Subject: Potholes in our locality is causing difficulties

Dear Sir,

With due respect, I would like to inform you that due to potholes in roads we are facing a lot of difficulties in our area. Monsoon season has already started a few days ago and is increasing our problems.

There is a risk that people might get hurt while driving on the roads having potholes especially with the childrens who play outside. Even for pedestrians it has become quite difficult to walk through the road.

Therefore I wish to draw the attention of the concerned authorities with the help of your newspaper. Hopefully, you will be able to help us in drawing their attention and resolving this matter at the earliest.

Thanking You,

Yours Sincerely,
Name & Signature

Birthday Party Invitation Letter

33, Fifth Avenue,
4th cross road
Mumbai - 89
Maharashtra

Date: 18th June 2020

Dear Preeti,

How are you? How are your family members? How is the weather there? Hope you are doing well. I am also fine here.

I am writing this letter to invite you for my birthday party which will be celebrated on 30th June 2020. The party will be conducted in my Lonavala's farmhouse. It will begin at 6 PM in the evening. The complete address of the venue is (____). If you have any confusion regarding the address you can directly call me on my phone number.

It's been a long time since we have seen each other. And I will be really very happy if you can attend my birthday party. Waiting to meet you soon.

Take care.

With Love,

Pooja

Thank You!